coursera | MoMA

What Is Contemporary Art?

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

Module 5
Agency

Visibility

- ✓ Introduction to Module 5
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Pope.L's New York crawls
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ In New York City with Pope.L | Direct action
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Two artists consider Catherine Opie, Dyke, 1993
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Tania Bruguera on Untitled (Havana, 2000), 2000
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Luis Camnitzer on Memorial, 2009
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Yara Said on the Refugee Flag, 2016
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Firelei Báez on For Améthyste and Athénaïre (Exiled Muses Beyond Jean Luc Nancy's Canon), Anacaonas, 2018
  Reading • 10 min

Voice

- ✓ Who speaks?
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Nick Cave on Soundsuit, 2011
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Conflicted Phonemes, 2012
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ P Staff on Weed Killer, 2017
  Reading • 10 min

Action

- ✓ Taking action
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Lorraine O'Grady on Mlle Bourgeoise Noire, 1980–83/2009
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Xiao Lu on Dialogue, 1989
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Ralph Borland, Suited for Subversion (Prototype), 2002
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Defining and blurring identities through performance
  Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond

- ✓ Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%
- ✓ Reflect on Agency in Module 5
  Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ **Optional Readings & Resources**
  Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Power

Optional Readings & Resources

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Below are **optional** readings and resources that provide additional context for the concepts and artworks featured in the course. Please note that these are **NOT required**; you can complete the course without reviewing them. You are also welcome to explore them after you complete the course.

Firelei Báez

The Modern Window: *Firelei Báez*, MoMA, November 17, 2018–June 15, 2019

Isabel Custodio, "Studio Visit: Firelei Báez," MoMA Magazine, November 14, 2018

Ralph Borland

Alex Vitale, "Suited for Subversion," Design and Violence, MoMA, October 1, 2014

Ralph Borland on moma.org

Tania Bruguera

Tania Bruguera, *Untitled (Havana, 2000)*, MoMA, February 3–March 11, 2018

Tania Bruguera, Stuart Comer, Leah Dickerman, "Dignity Does Not Rest: An Interview with Tania Bruguera," MoMA Magazine, December 14, 2018

Tania Bruguera on moma.org

Luis Camnitzer

"Luis Camnitzer by Alejandro Cesarco," BOMB Magazine, April 1, 2011

Luis Camnitzer on moma.org

Nick Cave

Nick Cave on moma.org

Nick Cave on Art21

Lawrence Abu Hamdan

Lawrence Abu Hamdan: *Walled Unwalled* and Other Monologues, MoMA, April 8–June 11, 2023

Ana Janevski, Erica Papernik-Shimizu, May Makki, and Lawrence Abu Hamdan, "A Studio in the Studio: An Interview with Lawrence Abu Hamdan," MoMA Magazine, April 5, 2023

art21 Extended Play: Lawrence Abu Hamdan

José Da Silva, "Interview: Lawrence Abu Hamdan—a self-styled 'private ear'," Art Newspaper, June 14, 2019

Artist's website

Lawrence Abu Hamdan on moma.org

Xiao Lu

"Monica Merlin interviews Xiao Lu," Tate Modern, February 21, 2018

Jean Wong, "History in the Making, But Who's Counting? A Critical Analysis of *Dialogue* (對話) by Xiao Lu (肖魯)," post, November 7, 2019

Xiao Lu on moma.org

Lorraine O'Grady

MoMA Learning: Lorraine O'Grady, *Untitled (Mlle Bourgeoise Noire)*, 1980–83/2009

Lorraine O'Grady on moma.org

Artist's website

Catherine Opie

Catherine Opie, "What to Do When the World's on Fire: A Conversation with Catherine Opie," MoMA Magazine, May 22, 2024

Kerry Downey and Ava Messina, "What's in a Name?" MoMA Magazine, June 24, 2019

Catherine Opie, Art21, April 14, 2012

Catherine Opie on moma.org

Pope.L

member: Pope.L, 1978–2001, MoMA, October 21–February 1, 2020

Exhibition audio for member: *Pope.L, 1978–2001*

Publica Art Fund, Pope.L: Conquest, 2019

André Lepecki and Stuart Comer, "Making Ways: André Lepecki on Pope.L," MoMA Magazine, January 24, 2024

"Malcom Peacock on Pope.L's The Great White Way," MoMA Magazine, February 29, 2024

Aria Dean, "The Trickster Art of Pope.L Draws Power from Negation," Art in America, November 20, 2019

Marta Popivoda

Bojana Jankovic, "Yugoslavia: How Ideology Moved Our Collective Body," exeunt magazine, May 31, 2014

Lauren Wissot, Marta Popivoda and Ana Vujanovic, " 'This Film is a Call to Solidarity, Self-Organization and Resistance': Marta Popivoda and Ana Vujanovic on their International Film Festival Rotterdam-debuting Landscapes of Resistance," Filmmaker, February 10, 2021

Marta Popivoda on moma.org

Refugee Nation

Refugee Nation, "Creating a Flag and an Anthem for the World's Refugees," Medium, September 28, 2016

Refugee Nation website

Refugee Nation on moma.org

P Staff

Sara Cluggish, "To Survive on One's Own Terms: P Staff on Weed Killer," Walker Reader, February 19, 2018

Lanka Tattersall, "Notes on Weed Killer," Los Angeles MOCA, March 2017

Lanka Tattersall, "P Staff: Weed Killer Walkthrough," Los Angeles MOCA YouTube Channel, June 25, 2017

P Staff on moma.org

Wu Tsang

Filmmaker and Performance Artist Wu Tsang | 2018 MacArthur Fellow

Alex Greenberger, "Take Me Apart: Wu Tsang's Art Questions Everything We Think We Know About Identity," ARTnews, March 26, 2019

Niloo Sharifi, "How Wu Tsang Is Rejecting The Confines of Identification and Language," Sleek, November 17, 2017

Wu Tsang on moma.org

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